

Amendment No. 1 to SB0695

White
Signature of Sponsor

AMEND Senate Bill No. 695

House Bill No. 505*

by deleting all language after the enacting clause and substituting instead the following:

SECTION 1. Tennessee Code Annotated, Section 49-1-225, is amended by deleting the section and substituting instead the following:

(a) As used in this section, "local education agency" or "LEA" means a county, city, or special school district, unified school district, or school district of a metropolitan form of government.

(b) The department of education shall administer a school safety alert program to provide funding to LEAs, public charter schools, private schools, and church-related schools for the purchase of mobile panic alert systems, as described in § 49-6-804(a). Mobile panic alert systems funded through the program must be approved by the department of education in consultation with the department of safety.

(c)

(1) There is created a separate fund within the general fund to be known as the school safety alert fund. Any funds remaining in the school safety alert grant pilot fund created in chapter 994 of the Public Acts of 2024 must be transferred into the school safety alert fund created in this subsection (c).

(2) Subject to monies available in the school safety alert fund, the department of education shall allocate and disburse funds from the school safety alert fund each fiscal year to LEAs, public charter schools, private schools, and church-related schools for the purchase of mobile panic alert systems.

(3) Any unexpended funds remaining in the school safety alert fund in any fiscal year do not revert to the general fund, but must remain available for future allocation and disbursement in accordance with this section.

(d) The commissioner of education may promulgate rules to effectuate this section. Rules must be promulgated in accordance with the Uniform Administrative Procedures Act, compiled in title 4, chapter 5.

SECTION 2. This act takes effect July 1, 2025, the public welfare requiring it.